Pupil studio resources & worksheet — Make the identity piece: pattern and portrait

Pathway: TRACK · Week 4 Part 1 · Big question: How can we combine a bold repeating background pattern with a high-contrast central identity subject?

Arrival check

Take out your Week 3 composition plan. Which area of your final card is smarter to map out in light pencil first?

[ ] The outer boundary of the central subject first, then the background grid behind it

[ ] Colouring one tiny corner of the background for an hour

[ ] Drawing with heavy black ink before checking scale

Starter visual cues

Step 1: Block in the central identity motif or portrait silhouette large in the frame.

Step 2: Divide the background into a rhythmic grid and repeat your chosen motif.

Step 3: Use oil pastel resist + translucent wash in the background, and solid opaque tone on the subject.

Step 4: Reinforce the outer contour of the subject so it steps boldly forward.

Vote: Why does combining oil pastel with a translucent ink wash work so well for a patterned background?

Studio practice planner

Confirm your central subject, background rhythm, and figure-ground separator.

Shapes/Focus: Bold symbolic crest, Stylised profile portrait, Interlocking personal emblem, Split-tone identity mask

Tools/Methods: Oil pastel resist + wash, Repeating geometric grid, Botanical motif border, Tonal collage + hatching

Exit ticket

What does 'figure-ground separation' mean in a composition?

[ ] Making sure the main subject stands out clearly from the patterned background behind it

[ ] Cutting the paper into two pieces

[ ] Drawing only on the floor